# Kitchen Talk and Black Ice

## By Jessica Care Moore

(Pronounced JE-si-kah Care MOOR)

. . . black girls are dying

Because no one showed them how to live . . .

*(From Warriors Walk Alone)*

## SOURCE INFORMATION

***Author: Jessica Care Moore***
***Book: The Alphabet Versus the Ghetto***
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## INTRODUCTION

*Black women are often invisible in American public life—and even when they're seen, they're not heard. But one poet is challenging the status quo. No longer will black girls face a symbolic silent death. They have a collective voice in Jessica Care Moore - an internationally known poet, publisher, performer and artist who has found her voice. It rings out strong and true – showing black girls everywhere how to live.*

*Black Ice and Kitchen Talk by Jessica Care Moore*

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## Kitchen talk

we cook with ntozakes recipes

we weave word quilts

we hide our stories inside our belly

we are the soft place language breathes before it's

pushed into sound

we are the whisper in the hush of crowds

we read eyes

we are warriors traveling without fear

or are we just a myth?

maybe black girls don't really exist at all

perhaps we are the vicious rumor

circling at the center of twice bitten snakes

maybe our mommas never taught us to bake

and this is the ancient secret that will save the world

that some black women can't fry chicken

or barefoot and pregnant is okay

if your husband paints your toes & pours your tea

we are the lie of rape the molestation of memory

creeping into our subconscious when someone says

he loves you after you've fallen out of love with him
or maybe this life is all just a fairy tale
and ndambi's little girl blue is the truth
cause words have hurt me deeper than any
blunt object or bullet chasing me down a detroit street
hell, we can duck or out run the hot steel
I'd rather pull a fast approaching word out from the air
and make your whole body stand still
make worship what you will
I wish for simplicity in moments
pray they'll understand why after six years
you still need to hear them to say how they feel
why you pretend to not put your pride
in the way of your walk
why your hair grease fried those eggs
& the last dollar to your name bought a sunflower
cause you are collecting dirt under your nails
and taking wolf dancing classes on Friday nights
anything but serve the ones who refuse to praise you
who defecated on your grandmommas spirit
the smell follows us, but our noses have fallen off

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or we have carved them up to take a better picture
still, we flip the pans and draw blood for aunt jemima
tomorrow morning, we will promise to protest the sun
we will beg for the night to save us & do cartwheels with
angels
who know damn well, our wings are still in the shop
but if you just give us some time - we will recover
like a child growing in her sleep, we are wiser after we
dream of being
awake . . .

## TRANSITION

*Awake and wiser . . . black women have grown in the proverbial silence. Today 19 black women serve in the US House of Representatives, ensuring that the voice of black women in America will be heard. But still there are challenges to be faced. A storm is brewing with a strong possibility of . . . . Black Ice.*

## Black Ice

we slippery, invisible
our freedom is frozen
cracking like leather whips
under your feet

there is a winter weather advisory
in the south
they are running
out of salt!

there is a police radio advisory
in the south
they are running
out of cotton!

no more fabric to support the confederate
so now the black kids can't wear fubu to school
let's design a nation from red dye and yellow # 5
let's teach the children how to lie

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let's make the truth real hard to find

there is a fire storm advisory
in the south
they are running!!!
out of reasons
to burn the books and wave the flags
we can't walk through the snow
when icicles dance inside our shoes
that's why daddy always seemed so cool
why the hot comb burns were a rights of passage
why god allows rain to turn to acid
& devils night fires never burned down my crib
why a summer longing never forgets the winters end

there is a thunderstorm warning
in the south

they are running!!!
out of water
to blast the fish people on the street

the niggas have turned to mermaids
their blood is a river of riots swimming
inside the sidewalk
bits of salt - blood fill the city ocean
the urban middle passage
laced with stolen beats & mtv pocketbooks
there is a starvation alert
in the south
black mothers are running
out of spices, salt, and water
they cannot cook and their sons are dying
they have greens to clean and they don't own any grass
their daughters are being born, already raped
innocence was exchanged for their eyes
so now they can't see themselves in the future
today an estimated one million blind black girls
are afraid to leave their block

there is a tornado warning
in the south
black people are running!!!

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in circles at the speed of light
twistin' and shoutin' and dancin'
around the death penalty
genocide is leveling the homes
of the black middle class
the ghetto is no longer a geographic location
the deaf wind is flying into our naive right ear
and out the liberal liars left
you think hiding in the basement
behind velvet rope couches
will save you new niggas?
there is a national time warning
in the south, black people are
running backward
sankofa style, moon walking
with dry sticks burning their palms
toward their forever chriogenic history
5-year olds are hitting their teachers in the head
with rubber bands and demanding african centered
curriculums
in all public schools

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in detroit, south africa, medina green, oakland
in atlanta, chicago, harlem, the children of brazil
are running for shelter

we are running in search of an unbetrayed earth
we are running from the weather our ancestors created
and we still haven't found a safe place
to drive down 85 south
without sliding on our elusive legacy
hiding inside patches

of invisible black ice

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## SOURCE INFORMATION

***Author: Jessica Care Moore***
***PoemHunter.com***
***(An NSDA Approved website for interp)***

***https://www.poemhunter.com/poem/kitchen-talk-2/***

***https://www.poemhunter.com/poem/black-ice-5/***